

Al-Fatiha — Complete Tajweed Analysis

Al-Fatiha (The Opening) is the most recited chapter — 17 times daily in prayer. Every major Tajweed rule appears in it. This is your ultimate practice piece.

Verse 1 — Bismillaahir Rahmaanir Raheem

- **Bismi:**

Laam in ALLAH is LIGHT (after Kasra — Bismi)

- **Allaah:**

The Laam has Shadda — strong emphasis

- **Ar-Rahmaani:**

Natural Madd on the long Alif (2 beats). Ra has Shadda — emphasized

- **Ar-Raheem:**

Natural Madd on Ya (2 beats). Meem Sakinah at end — stop = Izhar Shafawi

Verse 2 — Alhamdu Lillaahi Rabbil Aalameen

- **Alhamdu:**

Ha has no Madd — just light Ha from throat

- **Lillaahi:**

Laam in Allah is LIGHT (after Kasra — Lillaahi)

- **Rabb:**

Ba at end of word = Qalqalah bounce on stop

- **Al-Aalameen:**

Long Alif = Natural Madd (2 beats). Noon Sakinah at end — stop = Izhar Shafawi

Verse 3 — Ar-Rahmaanir Raheem

- Same rules as Verse 1 for Ar-Rahman and Ar-Raheem
- These two names together represent Allah's mercy — Fatiha reminds us twice

Verse 4 — Maaliki Yawmid-Deen

- **Maaliki:**

Long Alif = Natural Madd (2 beats)

- **Yawmid-Deen:**

Noon Sakinah before Daal → IKHFA (15-letter rule). Hold partial nasal.

Verse 5 — Iyyaaka Na'budu Wa Iyyaaka Nasta'een

- **Iyyaaka:**

Long Ya = Natural Madd (2 beats)

- **Na'budu:**

Ayn from middle of throat — strong, not a simple 'n'

- **Nasta'een:**

Long Ya = Natural Madd. Ayn again — throat letter

Verse 6 — Ihdinas-Siraatal Mustaqeem

- **Ihdinaa:**

Long Alif = Natural Madd

- **As-Siraatal:**

Saad is HEAVY (always emphatic) — darken surrounding vowels

- **Al-Mustaqeem:**

Long Ya = Natural Madd. Meem at end — stop = Izhar Shafawi

Verse 7 — Siraatal Ladheena An'amta... Wa lad-Daaalleen

- **An'amta:**

IZHAR — Noon Sakinah before Ayn (throat letter) → clear Noon

- **Al-Maghdoobi:**

Heavy Daad — emphatic, deep sound

- **Ad-Daaalleen:**

LAAZIM MADD — 6 beats! Long Alif + Shadda = longest Madd in Fatiha

- **Daad letter:**

Heavy emphatic D — tongue firmly to roof of mouth

- **Final Noon:**

Natural stop — slight Qalqalah tendency at end

Rules Checklist for Al-Fatiha

Rule	Where in Al-Fatiha
Laam in Allah	Light after kasra, Heavy after fatha/damma
Natural Madd	Rahman, Raheem, Deen, Maalik, Iyyaaka, Sirat, Ihdinaa
Laazim Madd	Ad-Daaaleen — 6 beats
Izhar	An'amtā — Noon before Ayn
Ikhfa	Yawmid-Deen — Noon before Daal
Heavy letters	Saad in Sirat, Daad in Ad-Daaaleen, Maghdoob
Qalqalah	Rabb at end of verse 2 when stopping

Final Advice

- ★ Recite Al-Fatiha slowly, applying one rule at a time until all become natural.
- ★ Listen to the Fatiha recited by Sheikh Hudhaify or Mishary Alafasy and follow along with these notes.
- ★ The Prophet (pbuh) said: 'Whoever reads the Quran and applies Tajweed will be with the noble righteous scribes (angels).' (Muslim)
- ★ You have completed the Tajweed course foundation. Now recite daily with awareness.